

■ FICTITIONAL DOCUMENT — FOR LEGAL/HR RESEARCH & TRAINING PURPOSES ONLY. The company, employee, and agreement below are invented. This contract intentionally embeds clauses that violate Ethiopia's Labour Proclamation No. 1156/2019, so it can be used as a "spot-the-violation" exercise. It is not a real contract and must not be used as a template for an actual employment agreement. See the annotated answer key on the final page(s).

EMPLOYMENT AGREEMENT

(A fictional agreement invented for this training exercise)

This Employment Agreement ("Agreement") is made and entered into on this ____ day of _____, 2018 E.C., by and between:

Employer: Horizon Garment & Textile PLC, a company organized under the laws of the Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia, of Akaki Kality Industrial Zone, Addis Ababa ("the Employer").

Employee: W/ro Almaz Bekele, holder of Kebele ID No. 0245781, of Addis Ababa ("the Employee").

The parties agree as follows:

Article 1 – Position and Probation

The Employee is engaged as a Sewing Machine Operator. The first nine (9) months of employment shall be treated as a probationary period, during which the Employer may terminate this Agreement at any time without notice, severance, or cause.

Article 2 – Working Hours

The Employee shall work seven (7) days per week, ten (10) hours per day. The Employee agrees that no weekly rest day is required given the nature of the garment business.

Article 3 – Overtime

Any hours worked beyond the daily schedule in Article 2 shall be considered part of the Employee's normal duties and shall not attract any additional payment.

Article 4 – Wages and Deductions

The Employer may deduct up to fifty percent (50%) of the Employee's monthly wage at its sole discretion, for disciplinary infractions, damaged materials, or shortfalls in production targets, without requiring the Employee's written consent.

Article 5 – Leave

The Employee shall not be entitled to annual leave during the first four (4) years of service. No paid maternity leave shall be granted; should the Employee become pregnant, this Agreement shall automatically terminate upon the Employer's notice.

Article 6 – Termination and Severance

The Employer may terminate this Agreement at any time, for any reason, without prior notice. In all cases of termination, regardless of the Employee's length of service, no severance pay shall be due.

Article 7 – Union Activity

The Employee agrees, as a condition of this Agreement, not to join or participate in any trade union. Any such participation shall constitute grounds for immediate termination.

Article 8 – Dispute Resolution

The Employee waives any right to bring a grievance before the Labour Relations Board or any court of law. All disputes shall be resolved exclusively and finally by the Employer's General Manager, whose decision shall be final.

Article 9 – Governing Terms

This Agreement represents the entire understanding between the parties and supersedes any conflicting provision of law to the extent permitted by the Employee's signature below.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have executed this Agreement on the date first written above.

For the Employer

The Employee

[End of fictional employment agreement. Continue to the following page(s) for the annotated compliance analysis, prepared for research/training use.]

Research Annotation:

Compliance Analysis Against Labour Proclamation No. 1156/2019

The table below maps each problematic clause in the fictional Employment Agreement to the specific provision(s) of Ethiopia's Labour Proclamation No. 1156/2019 that it would violate if it appeared in a real contract. Intended as a self-check / training key for HR practitioners, students, or researchers reviewing employment contracts for legal compliance.

#	Clause in the agreement	Provision(s) violated
1	Art. 1 — 9-month probation, terminable anytime without notice/severance	Art. 11(3) — a written probation period shall not exceed 60 working days from the first date of employment. A 9-month (roughly 270-day) probation far exceeds this statutory cap.
2	Art. 2 — 70-hour work week, no rest day	Art. 61(2) — normal hours of work shall not exceed 8 hours a day or 48 hours a week; and Art. 70 — workers are entitled to a weekly rest day, which this clause purports to eliminate.
3	Art. 3 — no overtime pay for hours beyond schedule	Art. 68 — a worker who works overtime is entitled to premium payment (at least 1.5x, up to 2.5x depending on timing); overtime cannot be reclassified as unpaid "normal duties."
4	Art. 4 — up to 50% wage deduction at employer's sole discretion	Art. 59(2) — deductions from wages may not exceed one-third (1/3) of the worker's monthly wage without the worker's written consent; unilateral deductions for damaged materials or missed targets are not among the lawful grounds in Art. 59(1).
5	Art. 5 — no annual leave for 4 years; automatic termination on pregnancy	Art. 77 — annual leave accrues from the first year of service (minimum 16 working days); and Art. 14(1)(b) & Art. 88 — discriminating against or terminating a worker because of pregnancy is unlawful, and pregnant workers are entitled to paid maternity leave, not termination.
6	Art. 6 — termination at will, no severance regardless of tenure	Art. 26–32 — termination must be based on lawful grounds (worker conduct, capacity, or operational requirements), not at-will; and Art. 39–40 — severance pay is a statutory entitlement based on length of service that cannot be contracted away.
7	Art. 7 — prohibition on joining a trade union	Art. 14(1)(a) and Art. 26(2)(a) — restraining a worker from exercising union rights, or treating union membership/participation as grounds for termination, is expressly unlawful.

#	Clause in the agreement	Provision(s) violated
8	Art. 8 — waiver of the right to the Labour Relations Board or courts	Part Nine (Labour Disputes) — the Proclamation's dispute-resolution mechanisms are a statutory right; a worker cannot validly pre-waive access to the Labour Relations Board or the courts as a condition of signing a contract.
9	Art. 9 — purports to override the Proclamation by agreement	Art. 4 (Scope of Application) / general principle — the Proclamation's minimum protections are mandatory floor standards; a contract term that is less favourable to the worker than the law is void to that extent, regardless of the employee's signature.

Note: This annotation references the article numbers in Labour Proclamation No. 1156/2019 as published in the Federal Negarit Gazette (5 September 2019). It is provided for educational analysis and does not constitute legal advice. For an authoritative reading, consult the official Gazette text or qualified legal counsel.